

Δωρόθεος ὁ Σιδώνιος

Dorotheus of Sidon on Astrological Technique

eul_aid: oho

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Ἐπιστήμη [Science](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Dorotheus of Sidon was a Hellenistic astrologer active in the 1st century CE. A native of the Phoenician city of Sidon, he worked during a period of synthesis between Babylonian, Egyptian, and Greek astrological traditions. No details of his personal life or education survive.

His sole known work is the *Carmen Astrologicum*, a didactic astrological poem composed in Greek hexameter verse. Originally in five books, it survives fragmentarily, primarily through an 8th- or 9th-century Arabic translation. The text systematically treats core techniques of Hellenistic horoscopic astrology, including zodiacal signs, planetary influences, and methods for interpreting natal charts.

Dorotheus is a pivotal figure in the transmission of astrological doctrine. His textbook was extensively cited by later authorities like Vettius Valens and, via its Arabic version, fundamentally influenced the development of Islamic and medieval European astrology. The work provides crucial evidence for the technical practice of astrology in the early Roman Empire.

Works (4)

- Ἀποτελεσματικῶν · [Fragments Drawn from Hephaestion's Apotelesmatica](#) · 19 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Πλανητῶν · [Fragments on the Planets](#) · 2 passages
- Ἑλληνικὰ Ἀποσπάσματα · [Greek Fragments](#) · 104 passages
- Ἄλλα Ἀρχαῖα Ἀποσπάσματα · [Other Ancient Fragments](#) · 7 passages